Violin

User Manual



The Parts of the Violin

Cautious

About the Bow

About the Bridge

Tuning

Maintenance and Care

Thank you for choosing AKLOT violin!

To ensure optimal performance and longevity of your instrument, please read this manual carefully.

WARRANTY

Any questions about the use of the product, you can contact our brand after-sales staff. We will solve your problem until it is resolved.

- 1-Year Warranty
- 24/7 Online Support

For product usage instructions, warranty extension services, or any questions regarding your order, please
scan the QR code below or contact our brand customer service team via email: [**cs@aklot.com**]

WARRANTY

IMPORTANT NOTES

- Exposure of the instrument and/or the bow to specific environments, especially abrupt temperature - changes, can lead to significant damage. To safeguard your instrument, please take the following essential precautions:
  - Avoid direct sunlight.
  - Keep away from extremely high or low temperatures.
  - Steer clear of overly high or low humidity levels.
  - Prevent exposure to excessive dust or strong vibrations.
- Do not leave the instrument in a car for long durations. The extreme temperatures, like those in summer and winter months, can damage both the instrument and the bow. It's crucial to protect them from such harsh conditions.

- Regularly clean your instrument using a soft, dry cloth. Under no circumstances should you use benzene, alcohol, or thinner. Additionally, refrain from using aerosol cans or any other sprays near the instrument. Such substances can harm the lacquer and overall condition of the instrument.

- Gold - plated components such as tuning pegs and metal frames may rust and fade over time due to the composition of their metal plating. However, this will not affect the performance of these components. When rust first appears, cleaning during normal maintenance and upkeep is usually sufficient to remove it. (If the rust progresses, normal cleaning may not be enough.)

- When playing the instrument, ensure you keep a safe distance from other people and objects at all times to avoid any contact. The bow's shape can pose a risk of injury if you're not constantly vigilant.

- When tuning or changing the strings, never hold the instrument close to your face. If the string breaks unex pectedly, it might result in injury to the eyes or face.

- When tuning the strings, do not over loosen or over tighten the fine tuner. Doing so may result in damage to the instrument, or cause noise disturbances during performance.

- Ensure that you loosen the bow hair before you put it away in your case after playing.

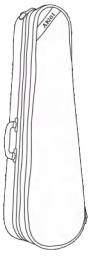
- Take care not to pinch your hands or fingers when closing the case.

PRODUCT SPECIFICATIONS

Upon receiving the product, please check each accessory in the kit against the list. If anything is missing, please contact us via our after-sales email address: **cs@aklot.com**. We will handle it for you as soon as possible.



Violin



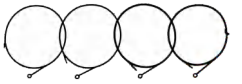
Hard Case



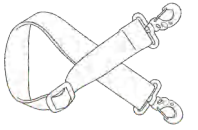
Bow



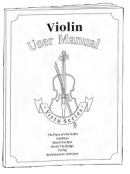
Shoulder Rest



Strings



Strap



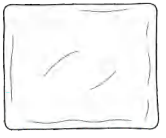
Instruction Manual



Lesson Book



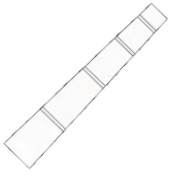
Tuner



Cleaning Cloth

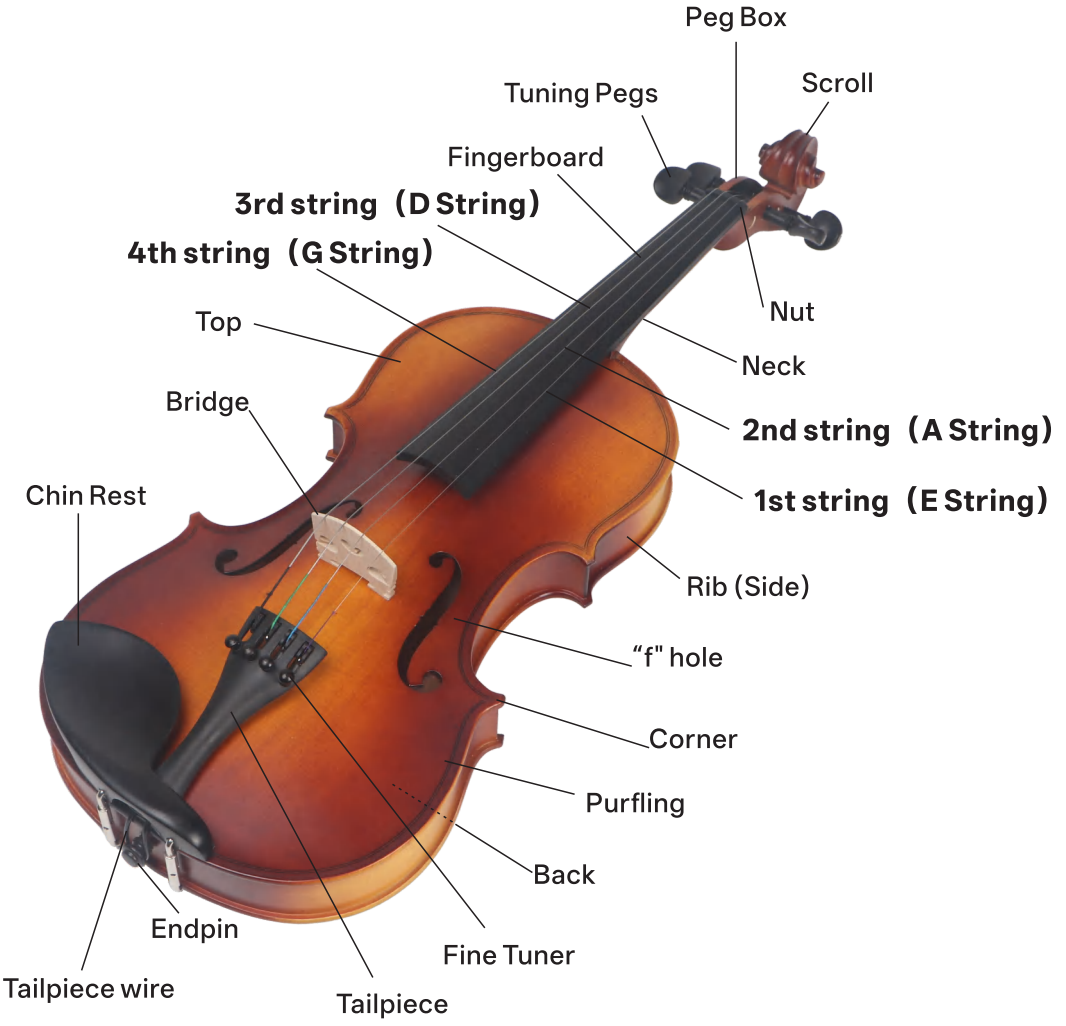


Rosin



Fingerboard Stickers

THE PARTS OF THE VIOLIN



ABOUT THE BOW

- **New Bow Instructions – Before First Use**

Loosen first: New bows come pre-loosened; tighten just enough to leave a small gap between the hair and stick—never pull it straight.



Rotate the button to adjust the bow hair tension.

Apply rosin: New bow hair has no rosin. For a new rosin cake, first scratch its surface with the bow's metal tip to create friction, then rub the rosin from frog to tip 5–10 times until the hair turns slightly white—do not overapply.

Play gently: Let the hair lightly touch the strings, draw the bow in a straight line, and avoid pressing hard near the bridge or fingerboard.







ABOUT THE BRIDGE

The bridge is preset before we ship out the violin, however, since it is not permanently glued on, and it's held down by the tension of the strings only, it might come out or misalign during shipment. If that happens, please reinsert the bridge into the proper position.

Bridge Instructions

Identify the orientation:

The bridge has two sides. The flat or slightly vertical side faces the tailpiece, while the angled or beveled side faces the fingerboard.

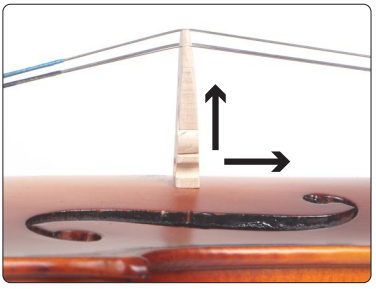
Check the position: Place the bridge upright between the inner notches of the F-holes, centered with the fingerboard. The vertical distance from the top of the bridge to the upper edge of the F-hole should be approximately 19–20 mm (about 3/4 inch).

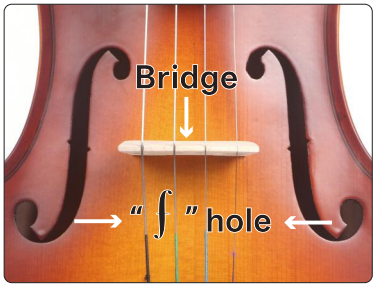
Keep it vertical: Viewed from the side, the back of the bridge (facing the tailpiece) should be perpendicular to the top plate.

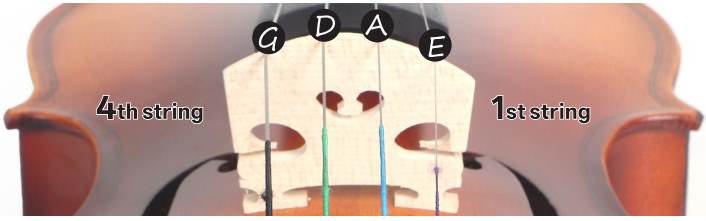
Straighten if tilted: Loosen the strings slightly, grip the bridge with both hands, and gently pull it back to vertical. Do not push from the top.

Never force it: If the bridge is severely warped or fallen, loosen all strings before repositioning to avoid damage.

Understanding the structure: The bridge transmits string vibrations to the top plate; the bass bar inside supports the left side under the bridge, while the soundpost inside under the right side transfers vibrations to the back plate. These three work together to produce the instrument's sound—proper bridge placement is essential for tone and structural stability.







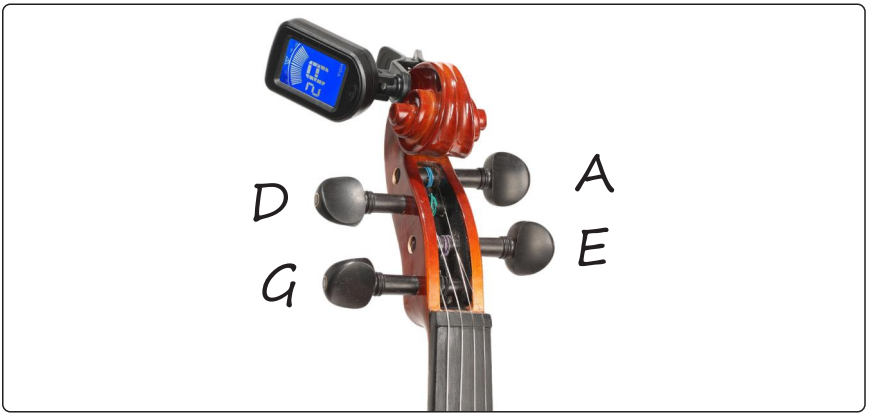
[Looking from the tailpiece]

TUNING

Violin Tuning Instructions

Thank you for purchasing our violin! An electronic tuner is included in the package. Please follow these steps for easy tuning.

Note: It is normal for new strings to go out of tune easily during the first few tunings. Repeat the fine-tuning process 2–3 times; once the strings have stretched and settled, the pitch will stabilize.



1. Prepare the Tuner

Turn on the electronic tuner and clip it onto the scroll (the curled part at the top of the neck).

2. Tuning Order

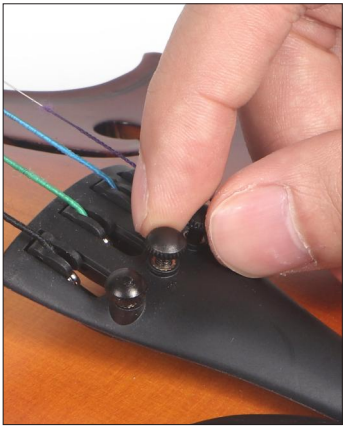
It is recommended to first tune the A string and D string (the two pegs on the left side of the pegbox), then tune the G string and E string (the two pegs on the right side). The specific order is: A (2nd string) → D (3rd string) → G (4th string) → E (1st string).

3. Peg Technique (Crucial!)

Push while turning: When turning a peg, simultaneously push it inward. Otherwise, the peg may slip and the pitch will not hold.

Small increments, multiple attempts: Adjust little by little, making only small turns each time. Do not try to reach the correct pitch in one large turn—large changes in tension can damage the string or even break it.





4. Fine Tuner Assistance

If the pitch remains slightly off after adjusting the peg, use the fine tuner on the tailpiece to make the final adjustments until the tuner displays a steady green light.

5. Final Check with Double Stops

After each string is tuned individually, you may bow two adjacent strings together (e.g., A+D, D+G, A+E) to listen for a harmonious fifth interval. If the sound is stable and ringing, the tuning is complete.

Violin Strings

Signs That Strings Need Replacement

Broken string: If a string snaps, it must be replaced immediately. This is the most direct and fundamental reason for changing strings.

Rust: The thinnest E string is especially prone to rust. Rusty strings feel rough under the fingers, affect playing comfort, and are near the breaking point—replacement is recommended even if not yet broken.

Fraying or unwinding: Most violin strings have a metal winding layer. Once this layer becomes damaged or split, the string is more likely to break suddenly. If the damage occurs where the fingers frequently press, it will significantly affect playing feel—prompt replacement is advised.

String Replacement Instructions

1. Preparation

Replace strings one at a time. Do not remove all four strings at once, as the soundpost inside the instrument may collapse.

Before installing a new string, apply soft pencil lead to the nut groove and bridge groove for smoother tuning.

2. Remove the Old String

Loosen the corresponding peg or fine tuner, then remove the old string.

3. Install the New String

Insert the ball end or loop end into the tailpiece or fine tuner hook.

Pass the other end through the peg hole, leaving approximately 3–5 mm protruding.

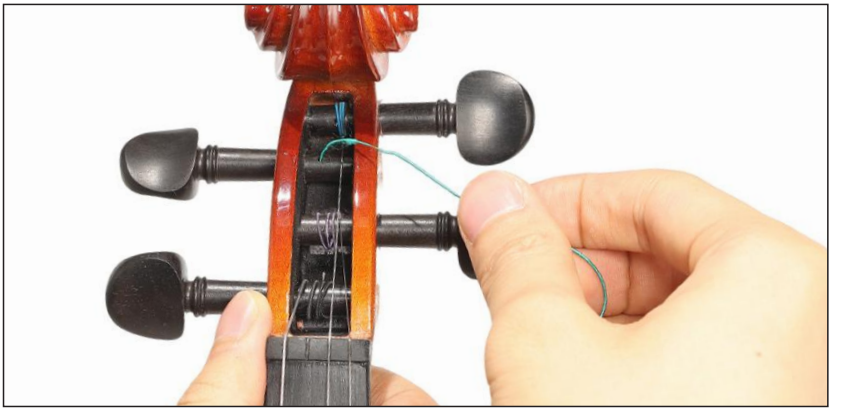
Winding direction:

A (lower left peg) and D (upper left peg): wind clockwise, toward the inside of the pegbox.

G (upper right peg) and E (lower right peg): wind counterclockwise, toward the inside of the pegbox.

Turn the peg while applying inward pressure to keep the coils neat and snug against the side of the pegbox.





4. Tune and Stretch

Tune to standard pitch using an electronic tuner.

Gently stretch the new string by pulling it upward with your fingers, then retune.

Repeat 3–4 times to stabilize pitch.

TROUBLESHOOTING GUIDE

This section covers the most frequent issues encountered by beginners. All checks can be done without specialized tools—quickly diagnose and resolve on your own.

Q1: The bow slips across the strings with little or no sound. What is the cause? How do I fix it?

A: There are two main causes. Check in this order:

① New bow hair has insufficient rosin. Apply rosin evenly from frog to tip until the hair turns slightly white.

② The bridge is leaning. Proper vibration transfer is hindered. Straighten the bridge so it stands upright, aligned with the notches of the F-holes.

Q2: The strings feel rough under my fingers, or they break frequently. What should I do?

A: Check two points:

① Inspect the string surface. If the winding is frayed, rusted, or peeling, replace the string.

② Check the nut (at the scroll end). If there are sharp edges, gently smooth them with fine-grit sandpaper to prevent cutting into the strings.

Q3: The strings go out of tune shortly after tuning, even after tightening the pegs. How can I fix this?

A: Two common scenarios:

① New strings need stretching. Tune roughly, allow 1–2 days for settling, then fine-tune again. Repeat as needed.

② The pegs are too slippery. Apply a small amount of rosin powder to the contact points of the peg to increase friction—no need to replace the pegs.

Q4: The bridge keeps falling over, especially during tuning. How do I keep it in place?

A: The bridge is held by string tension, not glue. Follow these steps:

① Position the bridge upright and centered between the F-hole notches.

② Turn the pegs slowly (about ¼ turn at a time) to avoid sudden tension changes that can tip the bridge.

Q5: The tone sounds muffled or weak, but the strings are fine. What else could be wrong?

A: Most likely the bridge is misaligned or the soundpost has shifted (common during shipping). First, straighten the bridge to the correct position. If the issue persists, have a luthier check the soundpost—do not attempt to adjust it yourself.

Q6: The outer winding of a string is frayed but the string is still intact. Can I keep using it?

A: Not recommended. A frayed winding creates uneven tension and is prone to sudden breakage during tuning or playing. It also affects finger feel. Prompt replacement is advised to avoid unexpected failure.

MAINTENANCE AND CARE

- ## Pre- and Post- Playing Cleaning:

Before each performance, gently wipe the body of the violin with a soft, dry cloth to remove any dust or debris that may have accumulated. This prevents scratches during play. After playing, thoroughly clean the instrument with a clean, soft cloth, paying special attention to areas under the strings, around the bridge, and on the fingerboard. These areas tend to accumulate sweat and rosin dust, which, if not cleaned promptly, can damage the instrument or affect the performance of the strings and fingerboard.

- ## Bow Cleaning:

After each use, gently wipe the bow along the direction of the horsehair with a soft cloth to remove rosin residue. Avoid applying excessive force to prevent damaging the horsehair. Periodically (e.g., once a month), hang the bow in a dry, ventilated area to allow the horsehair to relax naturally.

- ## Removing Rosin Stains:

If there are significant rosin stains on the violin, apply a few drops of specialized violin cleaning solution (or mild soapy water, ensuring it is promptly dried) to a soft cloth. Gently wipe the stained areas, then immediately dry with a clean cloth to prevent moisture from seeping into the instrument.

- **Regular String Checks:**

  Before each use, inspect the strings for wear, fraying or breakage. Replace significantly worn strings right away to avoid sudden breakage that may damage the violin or affect your performance. Generally, consider replacing the strings every 3 - 6 months. The actual replacement time depends on your playing frequency and intensity.

- **Peg Maintenance:**

  Regularly check if the pegs turn smoothly. If you find a peg too tight or too loose, apply a small amount of specialized peg compound to the contact area between the peg and the pegbox hole (never use ordinary lubricating oil, as it may stain the violin body). This will improve the friction and ensure accurate and effortless tuning.

- **Storage:**

  When the violin is not in use, it should be stored in a violin case to protect it from dust and physical damage.

  The violin case should be stored upright and not be placed under other items to avoid being crushed.